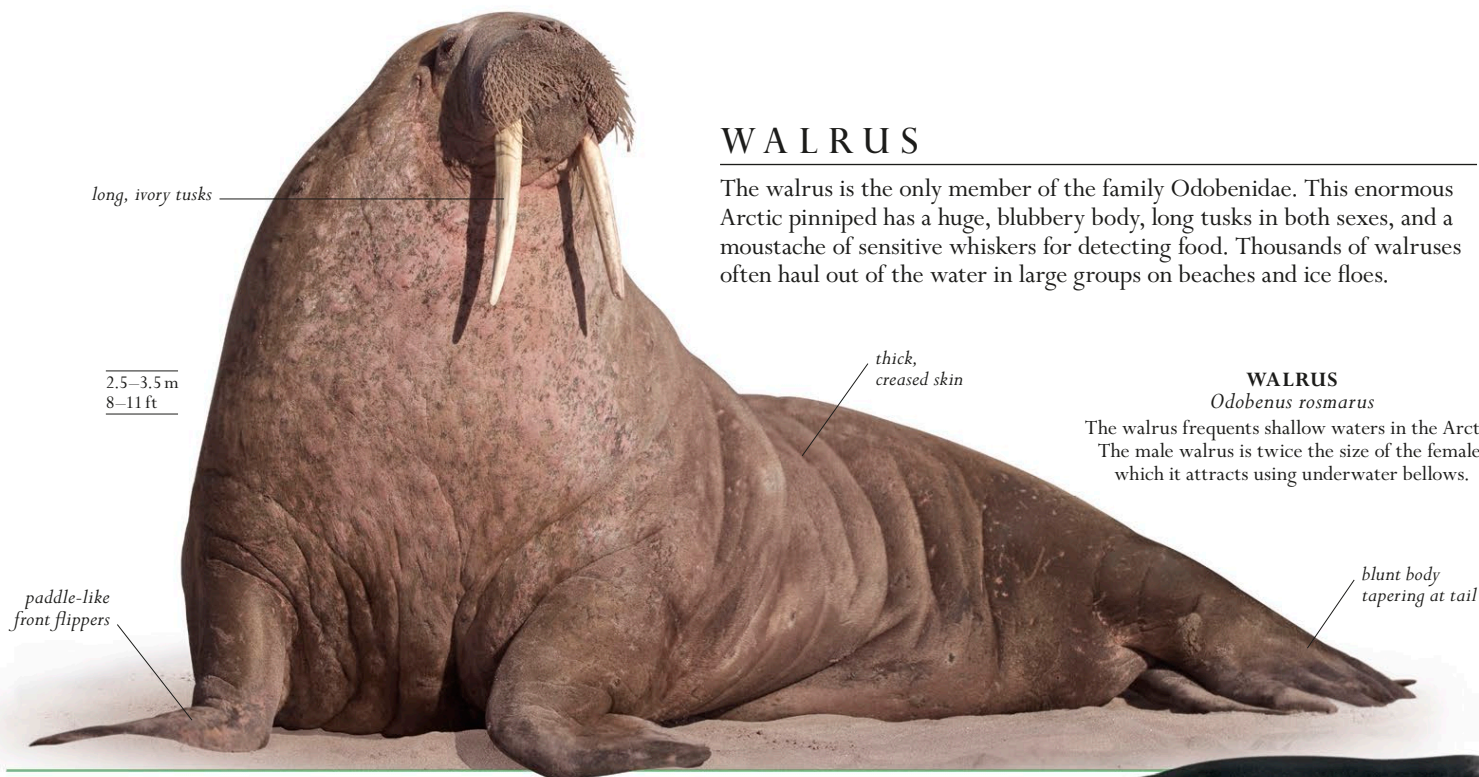




WALRUS

The walrus is the only member of the family Odobenidae. This enormous Arctic pinniped has a huge, blubbery body, long tusks in both sexes, and a moustache of sensitive whiskers for detecting food. Thousands of walruses often haul out of the water in large groups on beaches and ice floes.

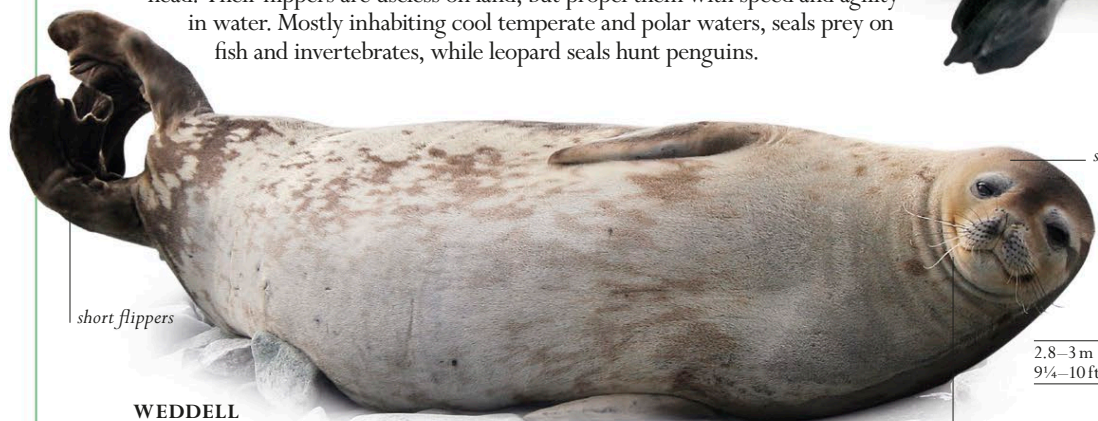
WALRUS

Odobenus rosmarus

The walrus frequents shallow waters in the Arctic. The male walrus is twice the size of the female, which it attracts using underwater bellows.

EARLESS SEALS

Also called true seals, the Phocidae are more adapted to life in water than their cousins, walruses and sea lions. In place of ear flaps, they have tiny holes on the sides of their head. Their flippers are useless on land, but propel them with speed and agility in water. Mostly inhabiting cool temperate and polar waters, seals prey on fish and invertebrates, while leopard seals hunt penguins.



WEDDELL SEAL

Leptonychotes weddellii

The most southerly dwelling wild mammal, this expert diver specializes in long, deep dives under Antarctic ice shelves. Females may be larger than males.



GREY SEAL

Halichoerus grypus

The grey seal lives in the North Atlantic, with large numbers breeding around Britain. Males are up to three times heavier than females.



ROSS SEAL

Ommatophoca rossii

This rare, fast-swimming seal spends most of its life hunting squid beneath Antarctic pack ice. Males are smaller than females.



LEOPARD SEAL

Hydrurga leptonyx

This fearsome predator mostly ambushes smaller seals, fish, and penguins at the edge of Antarctic pack ice, though it also eats krill.



BEARDED SEAL

Erignathus barbatus

This large, Arctic seal feeds on bottom-dwelling fish and invertebrates, which it locates partly by touch, using its long, stiff whiskers.



HAWAIIAN MONK SEAL

Monachus schauinslandi

Along with its Mediterranean relative, this is one of only two surviving, highly endangered and protected species of monk seals. Fewer than 1,000 of this species remain.



HARP SEAL

Pagophilus groenlandicus

This small seal migrates south in winter and north in summer in noisy groups, following the Arctic pack ice, on which it hauls out and rests.

